retribution ret · ri · bu · tion

Advanced Definition

noun

1. repayment for one's actions, esp. punishment for evil.

   The public were demanding retribution for the crime, and therefore the suspect had to be heavily guarded.

These are some examples of how the word or forms of the word are used:

1. After the publication of his first autobiography, Douglass feared retribution and fled the country to tour Ireland and parts of Europe.
2. Whether what followed was a just retribution on Jeffrey and Dorcas, for daring to take such liberties with their master's property as to exchange hearts, or whether it only goes to prove that with black as with white the saying holds, that "the course of true love never did run smooth," cannot now be told.

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